

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Brunnhilde

OCCUPATION

Adventurer, former Chooser of the Slain

BASE

Asgard

HEIGHT 6 ft 3 ins

WEIGHT 475 lbs

EYES Blue

HAIR Blonde

FIRST APPEARANCE

Avengers Vol. 1 #87
(April 1971)

Valkyrie has enhanced strength, longevity, and stamina; can perceive the onset of death, can teleport to the realm of the dead.

The Defenders were Valkyrie's extended family. As a core member, she helped the team fight off countless threats to the planet.



VALKYRIE

Odin, ruler of Asgard (see GODS OF ASGARD), made Brunnhilde the leader of the Valkyrior, giving her the task of bringing worthy warriors from among the slain to Valhalla. The ENCHANTRESS trapped her spirit within a crystal and kept it there for centuries, using it to invest herself and others with Valkyrie powers. In modern times, the Enchantress also assumed Brunnhilde's form to deceive the AVENGERS. She gave the powers of Valkyrie to the socialite Samantha Parrington, and later to Barbara Norriss, intending to use them as pawns. However, Brunnhilde eventually succeeded in restoring her consciousness into Norriss' body, and won back her original body. As Valkyrie, Brunnhilde joined the DEFENDERS and seemingly sacrificed her life to defeat the evil entity the Dragon of the Moon. She returned by inhabiting new host bodies, but perished in the events surrounding Ragnarok.

The Samantha Parrington version of Valkyrie has regained her powers and has continued her adventuring career. During the Civil War (see pp. 85-5) she registered with the US government and became part of the Fifty State Initiative (see pp. 118-9).

DW, MF



Wielding a mystical sword, Valkyrie deflects an energy attack.



VAMP

FIRST APPEARANCE Captain America #217 (January 1978)

REAL NAME Unrevealed

OCCUPATION Secret agent BASE Mobile

HEIGHT 5 ft 2 in WEIGHT 125 lbs EYES Blue HAIR Black

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES A trained secret agent, the Vamp wore an absorbo-belt that allowed her to duplicate the strength and physical skills of anyone around her.



Due to her excellent fighting skills, the woman known as the Vamp was selected to become one of the first Super-Agents of SHIELD.

Unfortunately, the Vamp was a double-agent, secretly working for the criminal Corporation, and assigned to infiltrate SHIELD. She had also been subjected to a genetic modification, which allowed her to transform into a psionically-powered creature called Animus.

Eventually, the Vamp's true loyalties were exposed and she was incarcerated. She subsequently became yet another victim of the notorious serial killer of Super Villains the SCOURGE OF THE UNDERWORLD. TD



VANGUARD

FIRST APPEARANCE Iron Man #109 (April 1978)

REAL NAME Nicolai Krylenko

OCCUPATION Adventurer BASE Belarus

HEIGHT 6 ft 3 in WEIGHT 230 lbs EYES Blue HAIR Red

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Generates force-field that repels most energy directed at him; also uses hammer and sickle to redirect the repelled energy.

Born in the Soviet Union, Nicolai Krylenko lived a life that was marked by deception and duplicity right from the start. Born with mutant powers, he and his twin sister Laynia were adopted by the state after their mother died in childbirth. Their father, a nuclear physicist, was told they were stillborn. Raised by the Soviet machine to be a counterweight to the increasingly prolific US mutants, Nicolai and

Laynia became members of the state sponsored super-team, the Super-Soldiers. Inevitably, they learned the truth about their background and since then Nicolai has pursued more semi-autonomous roles. He is currently a member of superteam, the Winter Guard. AD

VAN HELSING, RACHEL

FIRST APPEARANCE Tomb of Dracula #3 (July 1972)

REAL NAME Rachel Van Helsing

OCCUPATION Vampire slayer BASE London, England

HEIGHT 5 ft 8 in WEIGHT 135 lbs EYES Blue HAIR Blonde

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Expert vampire slayer whose preferred weapon was the crossbow; was also a parapsychologist and anthropologist.

Rachel Van Helsing was the descendant of Dr. Abraham Van Helsing, the 19th century nemesis of DRACULA. As a child she saw Dracula murder her parents to get back at Dr. Van Helsing. Rachel was raised by another of Dracula's enemies, Quincy HARKER. She became the most formidable member of his band of vampire slayers, frequently battling Dracula. After a troubled romance with her teammate Frank DRAKE, Rachel moved to New York State, where Dracula finally turned her into a vampiress. On her request, Wolverine impaled her through the heart, and she died peacefully. PS

